NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

REVISION HUB
SCAN TO LAUNCH

YEAR 8 ENQUIRY NORMAN CONQUEST, PLANTAGENET POWER, MAGNA CARTA & THE BLACK DEATH

THE EARLY MODERN WORLD (1450–1750)

Overarching Enquiry: "How did religious conflict, oceanic exploration, constitutional civil war, and popular resistance transform Britain and the wider world?"



PRIMARY PAINTING PLATE • SPIRIDIONE ROMA (1778) **THE BRITISH LIBRARY • EAST INDIA HOUSE**

'The East Offering Its Riches to Britannia'

Spiridione Roma's 1778 ceiling fresco commissioned for the East India Company House in Leadenhall Street, London, allegorically visualising the colonial extraction and transfer of Asian wealth to Britannia.

THE 8 HISTORICAL ENQUIRIES ACROSS THIS UNIT • KNOWLEDGE CHECKLIST 1066–1485

ENQUIRY 1
Global Power in 1450
- 1453 Fall of Constantinople & Ottoman Silk Road taxes
- Ming China's maritime retreat & Asian economic dominance
- European peripheral isolation & quest for spice routes

ENQUIRY 2
Religious Zeal & Exploration
- 1494 Treaty of Tordesillas: Papal division of the globe
- Protestant privateering: Drake & Hawkins raid bullion
- 1588 Spanish Armada defeat: English oceanic ambitions

ENQUIRY 3
Trade to Empire
- 1600 East India Company charter & Sir Thomas Roe in Agra
- Fortified coastal trading factories (Surat, Madras, Calcutta)
- EIC corporate armies & transition to territorial rule

ENQUIRY 4
Gunpowder Plot & Terror
- 1605 Gunpowder Plot: 36 barrels beneath Parliament
- Recusancy fines & James I's Divine Right of Kings
- Robert Cecil's surveillance network & Protestant identity

ENQUIRY 5
The English Civil War
- Divine Right vs Parliament: Ship Money & Personal Rule
- 1642 Civil War outbreak & Cromwell's New Model Army
- 1649 Regicide of Charles I & the Puritan Republic

ENQUIRY 6
The Financial Revolution
- 1688 Glorious Revolution & 1689 Bill of Rights
- 1694 Bank of England & National Debt fund the Navy
- Britain's transformation into a fiscal-military power

ENQUIRY 7
Transatlantic Slave Trade
- Triangular Trade architecture: outward, middle & homeward
- Horrors of Middle Passage & 1788 Brookes ship diagram
- Chattel slavery, sugar estates & human commodification

ENQUIRY 8
Enslaved Resistance
- Covert resistance: sabotage, culture & work slowdowns
- Armed insurrections: 1760 Tacky's Revolt in Jamaica
- Queen Nanny & Maroons win 1739 Sovereign Peace Treaty

HOW TO WRITE LIKE A HISTORIAN — 4 GOLDEN RULES & CONNECTIVES

THE 4 GOLDEN RULES OF EXTENDED WRITING:

1. Direct Thesis: Clear answer in sentence 1.

2. Specific Evidence: Names, dates, acts & data.

3. Causal Mechanics: Explain *why* & *how*.

4. Evaluative Balance: Weighted judgement.

HIGH-IMPACT ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:

Causation: *Consequently • Precipitated by • Directly resulted in*

Nuance & Evaluation: *Conversely • While ostensibly... in reality • Decisively*

THE 4 BIG STORYLINES TO TRACK — CORE HISTORICAL THEMES

1. Sovereignty & Power: Divine Right → Civil War, Regicide & 1689 Settlement (L4–L6)

2. Exploration & Trade: Ottoman fall → Tordesillas → East India Co (L1–L3)

3. Religious Volatility: Reformation → Gunpowder Plot & Puritan State (L2, L4, L5)

4. Enslaved Resistance: Triangular Trade → The Brookes → Maroons & Nanny (L7, L8)

LIVING UNIT TIMELINE • PART 1: GLOBAL ENCOUNTER & RELIGIOUS CRISIS (1450–1605)

PAGES 2–3 FACING SPREAD

Timeline Mission: In each lesson, turn back to this double-page spread to illustrate the milestone sketchpad with your visual symbol and key notes.

Chronological Spine • Facing Left

1453 **Milestone 1: Fall of Constantinople & Ottoman Hegemony** — May 1453 • Ottoman Hegemony — Lesson 1

Sultan Mehmed II's Ottoman forces breach the Byzantine walls using massive siege cannons. Controlling Constantinople and the Silk Road, the Ottoman Empire levies heavy transit taxes, forcing peripheral European crowns out onto the Atlantic to search for maritime routes to Asian spices.

1494–1588 **Milestone 2: Treaty of Tordesillas & Defeat of the Spanish Armada** — 1494 / 1588 • Mercantilism & Privateering — Lesson 2

Pope Alexander VI divides the globe between Catholic Spain and Portugal (Treaty of Tordesillas). Protestant England strikes back through state-sponsored privateering (Drake, Hawkins). When Philip II sends the 1588 Armada to invade England, English fireships and storms scatter the fleet, unleashing English oceanic ambitions.

1600–1615 **Milestone 3: Foundation of the East India Company & Mughal Trade** — 31 Dec 1600 • Joint-Stock Factory — Lesson 3

Elizabeth I charters the East India Company. English merchants operate as humble supplicants at the court of Mughal Emperor Jahangir, securing trade firmans to build fortified factories at Surat and Madras. Over time, commercial enclaves expand into private corporate armies and territorial rule.

1605 **Milestone 4: The Gunpowder Plot & Jacobean Surveillance State** — 5 Nov 1605 • Recusancy & Counter-Espionage — Lesson 4

Disillusioned Catholic conspirators led by Robert Catesby conceal 36 gunpowder barrels beneath the House of Lords. Discovered on 4 November, Guy Fawkes is captured. Robert Cecil's surveillance network weaponizes the conspiracy to enact ferocious anti-recusancy laws and solidify Protestant state identity.

Timeline Check: Why did the fall of Constantinople in 1453 force European crowns out onto the Atlantic Ocean? **See Milestone 5 Facing Right →**

LIVING UNIT TIMELINE • PART 2: CIVIL WAR, FINANCE & ENSLAVED RESISTANCE (1642–1739)

PAGES 2–3 FACING SPREAD

Timeline Mission: In each lesson, turn back to this double-page spread to illustrate the milestone sketchpad with your visual symbol and key notes.

Chronological Spine • Facing Right

1642–1649 **Milestone 5: The English Civil War & Execution of Charles I** — 30 Jan 1649 • Regicide & Parliamentary Sovereignty — Lesson 5

Constitutional collision over Divine Right, Ship Money, and religion plunges England into civil war. Parliament's New Model Army defeats Royalist forces. In January 1649, Charles I is executed outside Whitehall for treason against his own people; England becomes an unprecedented Puritan republic under Oliver Cromwell.

1688–1694 **Milestone 6: Glorious Revolution & Founding of the Bank of England** — 1688 / 1694 • Fiscal-Military State — Lesson 6

James II deposed in the Glorious Revolution. William III and Mary II accept the 1689 Bill of Rights, establishing constitutional monarchy. In 1694, the Bank of England is founded, creating the National Debt; Britain's new fiscal-military state raises millions at low interest to build the Royal Navy into Europe's supreme fleet.

c.1700–1780 **Milestone 7: The Transatlantic Slave Trade & The Brookes** — 18th Century • Triangular Trade & Chattel Slavery — Lesson 7

British ports (Liverpool, Bristol, London) dominate the Triangular Trade. British ships force over 3 million enslaved Africans across the catastrophic Middle Passage into chattel slavery on Caribbean sugar estates. In 1788, the abolitionist plan of the slave ship Brookes exposes the industrial scale of human commodification.

1739–1760 **Milestone 8: Jamaican Maroon Sovereignty & Tacky's Rebellion** — 1739 / 1760 • Maroon Sovereignty & Agency — Lesson 8

Enslaved Africans actively resist the plantation machine through sabotage, cultural preservation, and armed insurrection. In Jamaica, Queen Nanny leads Maroon guerillas against British regiments, forcing the Crown to sign the 1739 Peace Treaty recognizing Maroon sovereignty—proving black agency long before parliamentary abolition.

Timeline Check: How did the wealth generated by Atlantic trade and the 1688 financial settlement transform Britain into a global superpower?

Turn overleaf for Lesson 1 (Pages 4–5) →

CHANGE & CONTINUITY

Enquiry 1: Who held true global power in 1450, and why was Europe trapped on the edge of the world?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Explain the historical context, global geopolitical shifts, and competing perspectives of this enquiry.
- Deploy precise factual evidence to analyse cause, consequence, or second-order significance.
- Formulate an independent, evaluative historical judgement supported by causal reasoning.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Score: / 5

Q1: Which catastrophic pandemic struck Europe in 1348, killing roughly half its population?

Q2: What overland trade network historically linked China and the Mediterranean across Asia?

Q3: Which Christian empire, centered at Constantinople, fell to the Ottomans in 1453?

Q4: What was the primary source of wealth and power for medieval European feudal barons?

Q5: Which religious figure in Rome held supreme spiritual authority over Western Europe?

TASK 2: GLOBAL POWER BALANCE: OTTOMAN DOMINANCE VS EUROPEAN FRAGMENTATION (1450)

Balance the formidable geopolitical advantages of the Islamic and Asian worlds against the vulnerabilities of medieval Europe:

OTTOMAN & ASIAN DOMINANCE (THE EPICENTRE)

Point 1:

Point 2:

Point 3:

EUROPEAN PERIPHERAL FRAGILITY (THE OUTPOST)

Point 1:

Point 2:

Point 3:

✍️ **Task 2: Developing Your Argument: Explain why Ottoman dominance and European weakness forced oceanic exploration:**

Low-Floor Clue: In 1450, Europe was not the centre of the world; it was a fractured, impoverished peninsula desperate to find a sea route to Asian wealth.

★ ***Scholar's Edge:*** *How does Janet Abu-Lughod's concept of a "thirteenth-century world system" disprove the traditional Eurocentric myth of inevitable Western supremacy?*

TASK 3: HISTORICAL SKILL: CHANGE & CONTINUITY • EXTENDED WRITING

Enquiry: Who held true global power in 1450, and why was Europe trapped on the edge of the world?

INDEPENDENT ARGUMENT

1. OTTOMAN EXPANSION	2. MING ISOLATION	3. EUROPEAN PERIPHERY
Explain how the fall of Constantinople in 1453 secured Ottoman dominance over global trade.	Analyse why Ming China retreated from oceanic voyages despite possessing superior maritime fleets.	Formulate a sustained conclusion explaining why peripheral weakness forced European exploration.

Sentence Starters & Connectives: In 1450, global power was concentrated primarily in... • Crucially, geopolitical dominance across eastern trade routes meant that... • In stark contrast, peripheral European monarchies were... • This systemic imbalance directly compelled... • Ultimately, global oceanic expansion was driven by... because...

[P] Point: Clear direct answer to enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific names, dates, acts & data.

[E] Explanation: Causal mechanism (why & how).

[L] Link: Evaluative conclusion.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] **PEEL:** [P] • [E] • [E] • [L]

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3: *Illustrate Milestone 1 on Page 2: Sketch the Ottoman siege cannon, Mehmed II's overland galleys, or Constantinople.*

Pages 2–3 →

Enquiry 2: How useful are Source A (Visual: The Treaty of Tordesillas) and Source B (Textual: Hakluyt's Discourse) for investigating why European rulers risked everything to cross the oceans (1494–1588)?

DUAL-SOURCE UTILITY

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Explain the historical context, global geopolitical shifts, and competing perspectives of this enquiry.
- Deploy precise factual evidence to analyse cause, consequence, or second-order significance.
- Formulate an independent, evaluative historical judgement supported by causal reasoning.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Score: / 5

Q1: Which Chinese imperial dynasty deployed massive treasure fleets under Zheng He?	**Q2:** What city did Ottoman Sultan Mehmed II conquer in 1453, ending the Byzantine Empire?	**Q3:** Why did Ottoman control of eastern routes force Europeans to seek oceanic sea routes?	**Q4:** What disciplined standing elite infantry formed the core of the Ottoman military?	**Q5:** Why was 15th-century Europe described as economically and geographically peripheral?

TASK 2: THE EXPLORATION BALANCE SHEET: RELIGIOUS ZEAL VS COMMERCIAL WEALTH

Balance the religious justifications for global expansion against the commercial and strategic incentives driving European crowns:

RELIGIOUS ZEAL & CATHOLIC MONOPOLY (GOD)	COMMERCIAL WEALTH & STRATEGIC RIVALRY (GOLD & GLORY)
Point 1:	**Point 1:**
Point 2:	**Point 2:**
Point 3:	**Point 3:**

✍️ **Task 2: Developing Your Argument: Explain whether religious zeal or commercial greed was the primary driver of oceanic expansion:**

Low-Floor Clue: In the Tudor era, religion and profit were inextricably linked: Queen Elizabeth I sponsored privateers like Francis Drake to strike at Catholic Spain while enriching her royal treasury.

★ ***Scholar's Edge:*** *How does the Armada Portrait of 1588 visually combine Protestant religious providence with global imperial ownership?*

TASK 3: HISTORICAL SKILL: DUAL-SOURCE UTILITY • DUAL-SOURCE EVIDENCE

Enquiry: How useful are Source A (Visual: The Treaty of Tordesillas) and Source B (Textual: Hakluyt's Discourse) for investigating why European rulers risked everything to cross the oceans (1494–1588)?

EDEXCEL PAPER 1 & 3 PREP

SOURCE A (VISUAL): THE TREATY OF TORDESILLAS (1494)

Original papal diplomatic parchment agreed at Tordesillas in 1494, awarding all lands west to Spain and east to Portugal, legally barring England and France from the New World.

Record: GENERAL ARCHIVE OF THE INDIES • SEVILLE • PATRONATO 1-1-1

Provenance Clue: Official diplomatic treaty endorsed by the Pope; reveals how Spain claimed divine and legal ownership over newly encountered oceans and continents.

SOURCE B (TEXTUAL): RICHARD HAKLUYT, DISCOURSE ON WESTERN PLANTING (1584)

"This western enterprise will yield great profit unto our realm: providing naval timber and pitch, venting our woollen cloth, and employing our idle poor. Crucially, it will check the pride of King Philip of Spain, whose gold mines in the West Indies feed his war against Protestant England."

Record: BRITISH LIBRARY • LONDON • COTTON MS TITUS B.XIII

Provenance Clue: Secret strategic briefing for Queen Elizabeth I; emphasizes commercial profit, domestic unemployment, and geopolitical rivalry with Catholic Spain.

1. CONTENT & DETAIL

Analyse what Source A (visual meridian line) and Source B (written colonial proposal) reveal about Catholic monopoly vs English commercial ambition.

2. PROVENANCE & MOTIVE

Evaluate how the nature of each medium (official diplomatic parchment vs secret royal intelligence briefing) shapes its historical utility.

3. HISTORICAL JUDGEMENT

Weigh both sources: which provides superior insight into the religious, economic, and geopolitical drivers of oceanic expansion?

Sentence Starters & Connectives: Source A is valuable for revealing contemporary perspectives regarding... • However, as an official institutional record, it omits critical evidence concerning... • In contrast, Source B provides targeted insight into... • Cross-referencing both visual and textual evidence demonstrates that... • Overall, Source [A/B] is more valuable for investigating this enquiry because...

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] Source Utility: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] Provenance: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] **Judgement:** [1 • 2 • 3 • 4]

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3: *Illustrate Milestone 2 on Page 2: Sketch the 1494 Tordesillas meridian dividing the Atlantic, or Drake's fireships scattering the Armada.*

Pages 2–3 →

CAUSATION & CONSEQUENCE

Enquiry 3: Trade or takeover: How did humble English trading posts turn into a corporate empire?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Explain the historical context, global geopolitical shifts, and competing perspectives of this enquiry.
- Deploy precise factual evidence to analyse cause, consequence, or second-order significance.
- Formulate an independent, evaluative historical judgement supported by causal reasoning.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Score: / 5

Q1: What 1494 treaty between Spain and Portugal divided newly discovered lands?	**Q2:** Which English monarch licensed privateers like Drake to plunder Spanish bullion?	**Q3:** In what year did the Spanish Armada fail to invade Tudor England?	**Q4:** What German monk initiated the Protestant Reformation in 1517?	**Q5:** What precious metal mined at Potosí funded Spanish imperial armies across Europe?

TASK 2: COMMERCIAL ENCLAVES VS TERRITORIAL SUBJUGATION (MUGHAL INDIA & AMERICA)

Examine how humble merchant companies evolved into ruthless colonial rulers through military force and political manipulation:

PHASE 1: HUMBLE COMMERCIAL ENCLAVES (1600–1650)

Point 1:

Point 2:

Point 3:

PHASE 2: MILITARY TAKEOVER & TERRITORIAL SOVEREIGNTY (1700–1757)

Point 1:

Point 2:

Point 3:

✍️ **Task 2: Developing Your Argument: Explain how private commercial trade depots transformed into coercive colonial empires:**

Low-Floor Clue: The East India Company was not a government; it was a private profit-making corporation that built a private army of 260,000 men to control an empire.

★ ***Scholar's Edge:*** *How does William Dalrymple's concept of "The Anarchy" characterize the EIC's transition from merchant traders to corporate pillagers?*

TASK 3: HISTORICAL SKILL: CAUSATION & CONSEQUENCE • EXTENDED WRITING

Enquiry: Trade or takeover: How did humble English trading posts turn into a corporate empire?

INDEPENDENT ARGUMENT

1. COMMERCIAL ORIGINS	2. MILITARY LEVERAGE	3. INDIGENOUS IMPACT
Explain why European companies originally operated as humble supplicants to powerful Asian rulers.	Analyse how private company armies and political alliances turned commercial rivalry into military takeover.	Evaluate how taxation rights (Diwani) and territorial conquest destroyed local sovereignty and economies.

Sentence Starters & Connectives: Initially, European encounters in India and the Americas were characterised by... • However, as corporate influence expanded, commercial enterprises began to... • The decisive turning point occurred when... • This resulted in the direct transformation of... • Ultimately, commercial operations evolved into territorial dominion because...

[P] Point: Clear direct answer to enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific names, dates, acts & data.

[E] Explanation: Causal mechanism (why & how).

[L] Link: Evaluative conclusion.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] **PEEL:** [P] • [E] • [E] • [L]

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3: *Illustrate Milestone 3 on Page 2: Sketch Sir Thomas Roe before Emperor Jahangir, or a fortified coastal trading factory at Surat.*

Pages 2–3 →

Enquiry 4: Why was religious division such an explosive threat under King James I?

HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Explain the historical context, global geopolitical shifts, and competing perspectives of this enquiry.
- Deploy precise factual evidence to analyse cause, consequence, or second-order significance.
- Formulate an independent, evaluative historical judgement supported by causal reasoning.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Score: / 5

Q1: What type of commercial company allowed English investors to pool risk and capital?	Q2: What was the first permanent English colony in North America, founded in 1607?	Q3: Which Indian Islamic empire did ambassador Sir Thomas Roe visit in 1615?	Q4: What agricultural cash crop saved the Jamestown settlement from economic ruin?	Q5: What term described an armed coastal trading depot built by the East India Company?

TASK 2: RELIGIOUS RADICALISM VS STATE SURVEILLANCE: THE 1605 CRISIS

Analyse the escalating tensions between disillusioned Catholic conspirators and Robert Cecil's surveillance network:

CATHOLIC DISILLUSIONMENT & MILITANT PLOTTING

Point 1:

Point 2:

Point 3:

JACOBEAN COUNTER-ESPIONAGE & STATE RETRIBUTION

Point 1:

Point 2:

Point 3:

✍️ **Task 2: Developing Your Argument: Explain why religious division threatened state security and royal authority under James I:**

Low-Floor Clue: The Gunpowder Plot shocked contemporaries because it targeted the entire political establishment—the King, his heirs, Lords, and Commons—in a single explosion.

★ ***Scholar's Edge:*** *How did Robert Cecil weaponize the Gunpowder Plot to forge an enduring British national identity rooted in militant anti-Catholicism?*

TASK 3: HISTORICAL SKILL: HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE • EXTENDED WRITING

Enquiry: Why was religious division such an explosive threat under King James I?

INDEPENDENT ARGUMENT

1. VOLATILE CONTEXT	2. TERRORIST CRISIS	3. LONG-TERM LEGACY
Explain how broken promises of religious tolerance created radicalized Jacobean Catholic conspirators.	Analyse the catastrophic intended scale of the 36-barrel gunpowder plot beneath Parliament.	Evaluate how state retribution and anti-popery laws entrenched religious division for centuries.

Sentence Starters & Connectives: Religious division in this period was profoundly volatile because... • Specifically, growing disaffection among religious minorities was provoked by... • The escalation into clandestine conspiracy demonstrated that... • Consequently, the royal administration responded with... • Therefore, this crisis was of decisive historical significance because...

[P] Point: Clear direct answer to enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific names, dates, acts & data.

[E] Explanation: Causal mechanism (why & how).

[L] Link: Evaluative conclusion.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] **PEEL:** [P] • [E] • [E] • [L]

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3: *Illustrate Milestone 4 on Page 2: Sketch the 36 barrels in the Parliament undercroft, the Monteagle letter, or Guy Fawkes' lantern.*

Pages 2–3 →

Enquiry 5: How far do you agree with Interpretation 1 that the Civil War was an unavoidable fight against royal tyranny?

HISTORICAL INTERPRETATIONS

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Explain the historical context, global geopolitical shifts, and competing perspectives of this enquiry.
- Deploy precise factual evidence to analyse cause, consequence, or second-order significance.
- Formulate an independent, evaluative historical judgement supported by causal reasoning.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Score: / 5

Q1: What political doctrine stated that kings answer solely to God, not to Parliament?	Q2: Who was the militant Catholic mastermind who led the Gunpowder Plot in 1605?	Q3: How many barrels of gunpowder were concealed beneath the House of Lords?	Q4: What was the crime of refusing to attend compulsory Church of England services?	Q5: What anonymous letter warned Lord Monteagle not to attend Parliament on 5 November?

TASK 2: LONG-TERM CONSTITUTIONAL FRICTION VS SHORT-TERM ROYAL BLUNDERS

Examine whether the English Civil War was caused by deep-seated institutional friction or Charles I's immediate miscalculations:

LONG-TERM CAUSES: KING CHARLES I'S TYRANNY & THE FIGHT FOR LIBERTY

Point 1:

Point 2:

Point 3:

SHORT-TERM TRIGGERS: ROYAL BLUNDERS, MISTRUST & RELIGIOUS PANIC

Point 1:

Point 2:

Point 3:

✍️ **Task 2: Developing Your Argument: Explain whether King Charles I's long-term tyranny or his short-term blunders caused the Civil War:**

Low-Floor Clue: In January 1642, Charles I committed the unthinkable blunder of storming the House of Commons with armed troops to arrest five MPs; Speaker Lenthall famously defied him, declaring he served Parliament, not the King.

★ ***Scholar's Edge:*** *How does John Morrill's famous description of 1642 as "not England's first modern revolution, but her last war of religion" challenge the idea that the Civil War was simply a fight for modern democracy?*

TASK 3: HISTORICAL SKILL: HISTORICAL INTERPRETATIONS • HISTORIOGRAPHICAL DEBATE

Enquiry: How far do you agree with Interpretation 1 that the Civil War was an unavoidable fight against royal tyranny?

EDEXCEL PAPER 3 PREP

INTERPRETATION 1: LORD MACAULAY & G.M. TREVELYAN (TRADITIONAL VIEW: FIGHT AGAINST TYRANNY)

THE TRADITIONAL VIEW: INEVITABLE FIGHT FOR PARLIAMENTARY FREEDOM

"The clash between King and Parliament was the grand heroic struggle of English history. Charles I was an unbending tyrant who sought to extinguish ancient liberties through illegal taxes like Ship Money and eleven years of Personal Rule. The Civil War was the inevitable, necessary triumph of parliamentary freedom, rule of law, and Protestant democracy over royal absolutism."

Scholar: Lord Macaulay (19th-Century Historian & Statesman)

INTERPRETATION 2: PROFESSOR CONRAD RUSSELL & JOHN MORRILL (MODERN VIEW: AN ACCIDENTAL WAR)

THE MODERN VIEW: AN ACCIDENTAL DISASTER OF PANIC & MISTRUST

"The Civil War was neither inevitable nor primarily about modern constitutional liberty. It was a tragic, unforced breakdown caused by the personal untrustworthiness of Charles I and explosive religious fear. In 1640, nobody wanted war; England stumbled into disaster because the King failed to govern three distinct kingdoms—England, Scotland, and Ireland—simultaneously."

Scholar: Conrad Russell (Professor of Commonwealth History, King's College London)

1. INTERPRETATION 1 CLAIMS

Analyse Macaulay's argument that Charles I's tyranny and illegal taxes made war unavoidable.

2. INTERPRETATION 2 CRITIQUE

Evaluate Russell's modern counter-argument that war was an accidental disaster caused by religious fear and royal blunders.

3. HISTORIOGRAPHICAL VERDICT

Weigh both interpretations against factual evidence (1642 Militia Ordinance, Bishops' Wars) to reach an independent verdict.

Sentence Starters & Connectives: Interpretation 1 asserts that the outbreak of armed conflict was unavoidable because... • This perspective is corroborated by evidence demonstrating that... • However, Interpretation 2 challenges this thesis, contending instead that... • In particular, this alternative interpretation emphasizes that... • On balance, Interpretation [1/2] provides a more convincing explanation because...

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] Interpretation Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] Evaluation: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] **Balance:** [1 • 2 • 3 • 4]

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3: *Illustrate Milestone 5 on Page 3: Sketch Charles I raising his standard at Nottingham, or the execution scaffold outside Whitehall.*

Pages 2–3 →

TURNING POINT ANALYSIS

Enquiry 6: How did a Dutch invasion and the Bank of England turn Britain into a global superpower?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Explain the historical context, global geopolitical shifts, and competing perspectives of this enquiry.
- Deploy precise factual evidence to analyse cause, consequence, or second-order significance.
- Formulate an independent, evaluative historical judgement supported by causal reasoning.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Score: / 5

Q1: What illegal coastal tax did Charles I extend inland during his Personal Rule?	Q2: In what year was King Charles I publicly executed outside Whitehall Banqueting House?	Q3: What disciplined parliamentary army was established by Fairfax and Cromwell in 1645?	Q4: What title did Oliver Cromwell assume as head of the Commonwealth in 1653?	Q5: What legal term defines the formal judicial execution of a reigning monarch?

TASK 2: STUART CATHOLIC ABSOLUTISM VS THE 1688 CONSTITUTIONAL SETTLEMENT

Analyse how the replacement of James II with William III and Mary II established a modern fiscal-military state:

STUART CATHOLIC AUTOCRACY (PRE-1688 CRISIS)

Point 1:

Point 2:

Point 3:

THE 1688 SETTLEMENT & FISCAL-MILITARY POWER

Point 1:

Point 2:

Point 3:

✍ **Task 2: Developing Your Argument: Explain how the 1688 settlement and the Financial Revolution created a modern superpower:**

Low-Floor Clue: The Glorious Revolution was not just about religion; by guaranteeing that Parliament controlled taxes, it allowed Britain to borrow money cheaply and build the world's greatest navy.

★ ***Scholar's Edge:*** *How did John Brewer's concept of the "Fiscal-Military State" explain Britain's ability to defeat much larger continental rivals like France after 1688?*

TASK 3: HISTORICAL SKILL: TURNING POINT ANALYSIS • EXTENDED WRITING

Enquiry: How did a Dutch invasion and the Bank of England turn Britain into a global superpower?

INDEPENDENT ARGUMENT

1. RELIGIOUS CRISIS	2. BILL OF RIGHTS	3. FINANCIAL REVOLUTION
Explain why James II's pro-Catholic policies provoked the Immortal Seven to invite William of Orange.	Analyse how the 1689 constitutional settlement permanently subordinated royal prerogative to Parliament.	Evaluate how the Bank of England and National Debt enabled Britain to project global military power.

Sentence Starters & Connectives: The constitutional settlement marked a decisive turning point because... • The immediate catalyst was... • Consequently, the new legal framework established that... • Furthermore, institutional reforms revolutionised... • Ultimately, the decisive transformation was... because...

[P] Point: Clear direct answer to enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific names, dates, acts & data.

[E] Explanation: Causal mechanism (why & how).

[L] Link: Evaluative conclusion.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] **PEEL:** [P] • [E] • [E] • [L]

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3: *Illustrate Milestone 6 on Page 3: Sketch the 1689 Bill of Rights parchment, or the founding charter and gold vaults of the Bank of England.*

Pages 2–3 →

HISTORICAL EVIDENCE & CAUSE

Enquiry 7: What was the true human cost and commercial scale of the Transatlantic Slave Trade?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Explain the historical context, global geopolitical shifts, and competing perspectives of this enquiry.
- Deploy precise factual evidence to analyse cause, consequence, or second-order significance.
- Formulate an independent, evaluative historical judgement supported by causal reasoning.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Score: / 5

Q1: What 1689 statute permanently subordinated royal prerogative to Parliament?	**Q2:** What central bank was founded in 1694 to manage national borrowing and fund the Navy?	**Q3:** What Dutch ruler was invited by Parliament to replace James II in the Glorious Revolution?	**Q4:** What economic doctrine held that national power required hoarding silver and gold bullion?	**Q5:** What financial innovation allowed the British government to borrow money cheaply?

TASK 2: COMMERCIAL PROFIT ARCHITECTURE VS THE REALITY OF THE MIDDLE PASSAGE

Examine the brutal contradiction between British commercial enrichment and the industrial dehumanization of African captives:

COMMERCIAL MACHINE & BRITISH PORTS (THE OUTWARD & HOMEWARD LEGS)

Point 1:

Point 2:

Point 3:

DEHUMANIZATION OF THE MIDDLE PASSAGE (THE INWARD LEG)

Point 1:

Point 2:

Point 3:

✍️ **Task 2: Developing Your Argument: Explain the contradiction between British domestic wealth and the inhumanity of the Middle Passage:**

Low-Floor Clue: In 1788, the Abolition Society published a technical architectural plan of the slave ship Brookes; its chilling diagram showed human beings stacked like cargo in the hold.

★ ***Scholar's Edge:*** *How does Eric Williams's landmark "Capitalism and Slavery" thesis argue that the profits of Atlantic slavery directly financed Britain's Industrial Revolution?*

TASK 3: HISTORICAL SKILL: HISTORICAL EVIDENCE & CAUSE • EXTENDED WRITING

Enquiry: What was the true human cost and commercial scale of the Transatlantic Slave Trade?

INDEPENDENT ARGUMENT

1. TRIANGULAR SYSTEM	2. MIDDLE PASSAGE	3. ECONOMIC IMPACT
Explain how the three legs of the triangular trade operated to maximize European mercantile profits.	Deploy primary evidence from Equiano and the Brookes diagram to analyse the horrors of the crossing.	Evaluate how British cities, industries, and financial institutions became deeply entangled with slavery.

Sentence Starters & Connectives: This trade system functioned as a ruthless commercial machine because... • In particular, commercial networks operated by... • Furthermore, conditions endured by victims demonstrate that... • Primary architectural evidence reveals that... • Consequently, long-term economic wealth was built upon...

[P] Point: Clear direct answer to enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific names, dates, acts & data.

[E] Explanation: Causal mechanism (why & how).

[L] Link: Evaluative conclusion.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] **PEEL:** [P] • [E] • [E] • [L]

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3: *Illustrate Milestone 7 on Page 3: Sketch the brutal plan of the slave ship Brookes, or the triangular flow of goods, captives, and sugar.*

Pages 2–3 →

Enquiry 8: How did enslaved Africans fight back and dismantle the plantation system from within?

AGENCY & HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Explain the historical context, global geopolitical shifts, and competing perspectives of this enquiry.
- Deploy precise factual evidence to analyse cause, consequence, or second-order significance.
- Formulate an independent, evaluative historical judgement supported by causal reasoning.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Score: / 5

Q1: What three-cornered oceanic trade route linked Britain, West Africa, and the Americas?	**Q2:** What was the harrowing middle leg transporting captured Africans called?	**Q3:** What 1788 architectural plan exposed over 450 enslaved people crammed into a ship's hold?	**Q4:** Which two British ports expanded dramatically from trading slave-produced sugar and tobacco?	**Q5:** What legal classification treated enslaved human beings as personal property?

TASK 2: EVERYDAY COVERT RESISTANCE VS MILITANT GUERILLA INSURRECTION

Assess the multifaceted ways enslaved people asserted their humanity and fought for freedom against overwhelming colonial force:

EVERYDAY COVERT RESISTANCE (PLANTATION AGENCY)

Point 1:

Point 2:

Point 3:

MILITANT ARMED INSURRECTION & MAROON SOVEREIGNTY

Point 1:

Point 2:

Point 3:

✍️ **Task 2: Developing Your Argument: Explain how everyday resistance and armed insurrections actively challenged chattel slavery:**

Low-Floor Clue: In 1739, after decades of guerilla war in the Jamaican mountains, the mighty British Empire was forced to negotiate a formal peace treaty with Queen Nanny, granting her people 1,500 acres of sovereign land.

★ ***Scholar's Edge:*** *How does highlighting African agency and rebellion correct the flawed traditional narrative that abolition was solely the charitable gift of white politicians like William Wilberforce?*

TASK 3: HISTORICAL SKILL: AGENCY & HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE • EXTENDED WRITING

Enquiry: How did enslaved Africans fight back and dismantle the plantation system from within?

INDEPENDENT ARGUMENT

1. COVERT RESISTANCE	2. ARMED INSURRECTION	3. MAROON VICTORY
Explain how everyday acts of sabotage and cultural preservation resisted chattel dehumanization.	Analyse the military impact of shipboard revolts and Tacky's 1760 rebellion in Jamaica.	Evaluate how Queen Nanny and the Maroons forced the British state into recognizing autonomous freedom.

Sentence Starters & Connectives: Enslaved populations constantly challenged the plantation system through... • On a daily basis, covert resistance was expressed by... • More directly, organized armed uprisings demonstrated that... • Furthermore, autonomous resistance communities proved that... • Ultimately, the historical significance of sustained resistance is that...

[P] Point: Clear direct answer to enquiry. **[E] Evidence:** Specific names, dates, acts & data. **[E] Explanation:** Causal mechanism (why & how). **[L] Link:** Evaluative conclusion.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] **PEEL:** [P] • [E] • [E] • [L]

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3: *Illustrate Milestone 8 on Page 3: Sketch Queen Nanny's Blue Mountain fighters, or the signing of the 1739 Maroon Peace Treaty.*

Pages 2–3 →

THE HISTORY DEPARTMENT

KEY STAGE 3 HISTORY • PUPIL ASSESSMENT RECORD

UNIT: THE EARLY MODERN WORLD (1450–1750)

PUPIL NAME: _____ **CLASS:** _____ **TARGET LEVEL:** _____

KS3 PATHWAY	**Emerging (1–2):** Isolated facts; basic descriptive recall.	**Developing (3):** Identifies causes & features with simple explanation.	**Secure (4–5):** Structured PEEL arguments with precise facts.	**Advanced (6–7):** Evaluates competing causes; nuanced explanation.	**Mastery (8–9):** Sustained historical criteria & historiographical verdicts.
EFFORT RUBRIC	**1 • Concern:** Incomplete work.	**2 • Inconsistent:** Needs prompts.	**3 • Satisfactory:** Meets baseline.	**4 • Good:** Thoughtful scholar.	**5 • Exemplary:** Exceptional pride.

#	ENQUIRY TITLE	HISTORICAL SKILL	DO NOW	TASK 4 GRADE	EFFORT	TEACHER FEEDBACK
L1	Ottoman Power	Change & Continuity	[/5]	[ ]	1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5	
L2	Early Empire	Dual-Source Utility	[/5]	[ ]	1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5	
L3	Mughal India	Causation & Consequence	[/5]	[ ]	1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5	
L4	Jacobean State	Historical Significance	[/5]	[ ]	1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5	
L5	Civil War	Historical Interpretations	[/5]	[ ]	1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5	
L6	Glorious Rev.	Turning Point Analysis	[/5]	[ ]	1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5	
L7	Atlantic Slave	Historical Evidence & Cause	[/5]	[ ]	1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5	
L8	Resistance	Agency & Historical Significance	[/5]	[ ]	1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5	
UNIT SUMMATIVE OUTCOME			**[/40]**	[ ]	**[1 2 3 4 5]**	**Signed:** _____ • **Date:** ___/___/2026

OVERALL UNIT FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT & ACADEMIC GUIDANCE — KEY STAGE 3 MASTERY

WHAT WENT WELL (WWW):

_____

_____

EVEN BETTER IF (EBI):

_____

_____

INTERACTIVE DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • SCAN FOR INSTANT SELF-MARKING QUIZZES (8 LESSONS • 160 QUESTIONS) — Instant Recall Practice

L1 Ottoman Power	L2 Early Empire	L3 Mughal India	L4 Jacobean State	L5 Civil War	L6 Glorious Rev.	L7 Atlantic Slave	L8 Resistance
Scan to Quiz	Scan to Quiz	Scan to Quiz	Scan to Quiz	Scan to Quiz	Scan to Quiz	Scan to Quiz	Scan to Quiz
[/20]	[/20]	[/20]	[/20]	[/20]	[/20]	[/20]	[/20]

SUMMER ASSESSMENT REVISION PROTOCOL • 4 EVIDENCE-BASED RETRIEVAL TECHNIQUES — COGNITIVE SCIENCE IN PRACTICE

1. Spaced Flash Quizzing
Scan each QR code weekly. Retest until you score 100% on factual recall before checking your workbook notes.

2. Dual-Coding Timeline Walk
Turn to Pages 2–3. Cover the written text and narrate the historical story aloud using only your sketchpad symbols.

3. 5-Minute Brain Dumps
Pick an enquiry question. Spend 5 uninterrupted minutes writing every name, date, and cause from memory.

4. Causal Connective Drills
Draft 3 PEEL sentences explaining *why* an event happened using: *Consequently... This directly resulted in...*